16.2 Preterm and Low Birth Weight Infant

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Born at 32 weeks, weight 1.5 kg • Temperature 36.0 °C • Very little fat under the skin	**ACTUAL** **Ineffective thermoregulation** related to immaturity and little subcutaneous fat as evidenced by low temperature.	Temperature kept at 36.5–37.5 °C.	• Nurse in an incubator or under a radiant warmer as ordered. • Once stable, use kangaroo mother care. • Keep the baby covered as much as possible during procedures. • Temperature every 3–4 hours.	Temperature normal: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Suck and swallow weak • Cannot coordinate feeding well	**ACTUAL** **Ineffective infant feeding dynamics** related to prematurity as evidenced by weak suck and poor coordination.	Gains weight steadily.	• Give expressed breast milk by tube or cup as ordered. • Help the mother to express. • Weigh every day and chart intake. • Move on to breastfeeding as the baby can manage.	Gaining weight: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Born early • Having invasive procedures	**RISK** **Risk for infection** as evidenced by risk factors: immature immunity and invasive procedures.	Stays free of infection.	• Strict hand hygiene. • Aseptic care of all lines. • Watch for unstable temperature, poor feeding and lethargy.	No infection: **goal met**.